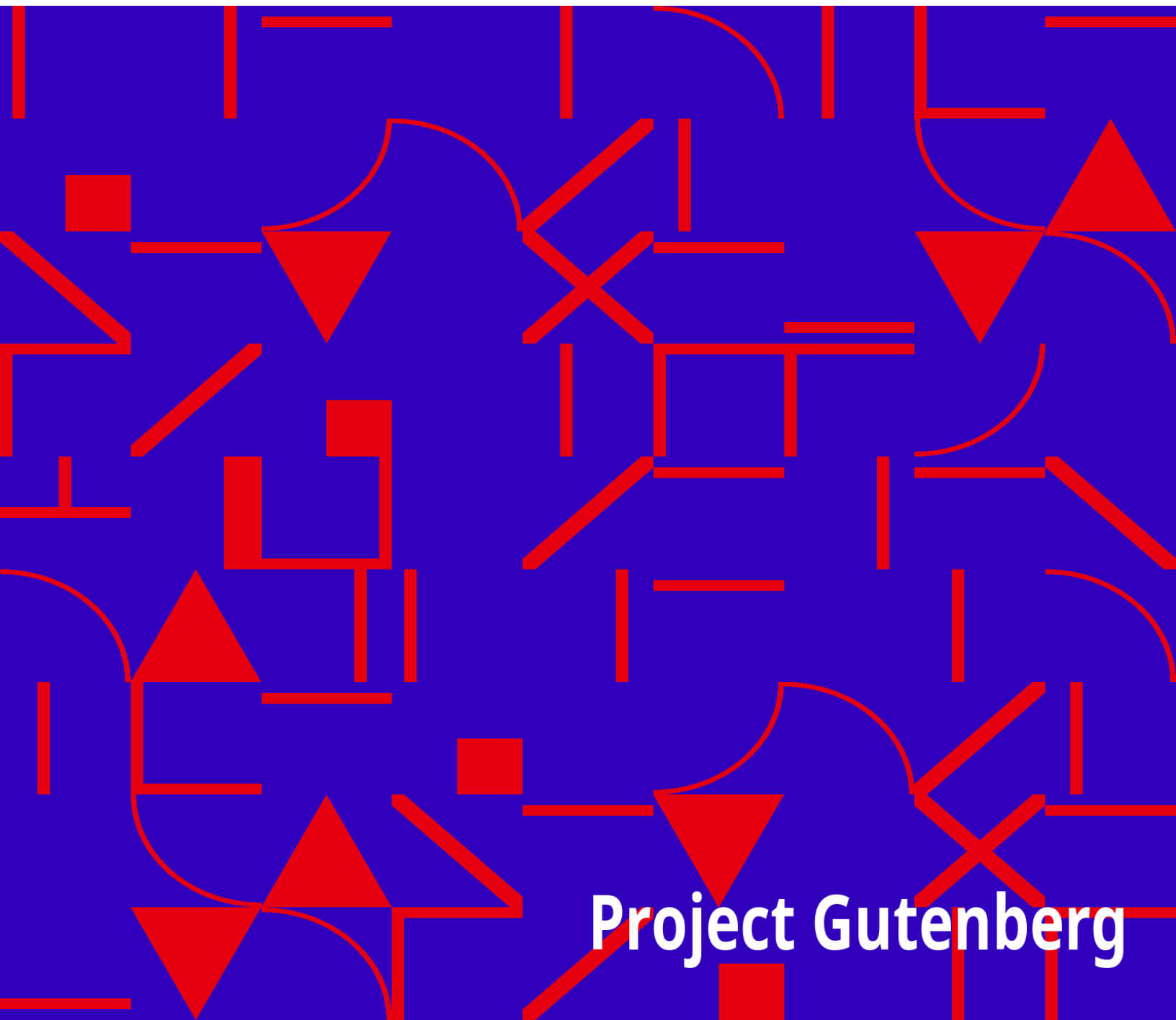


The Bible, King James version, Book 16: Nehemiah

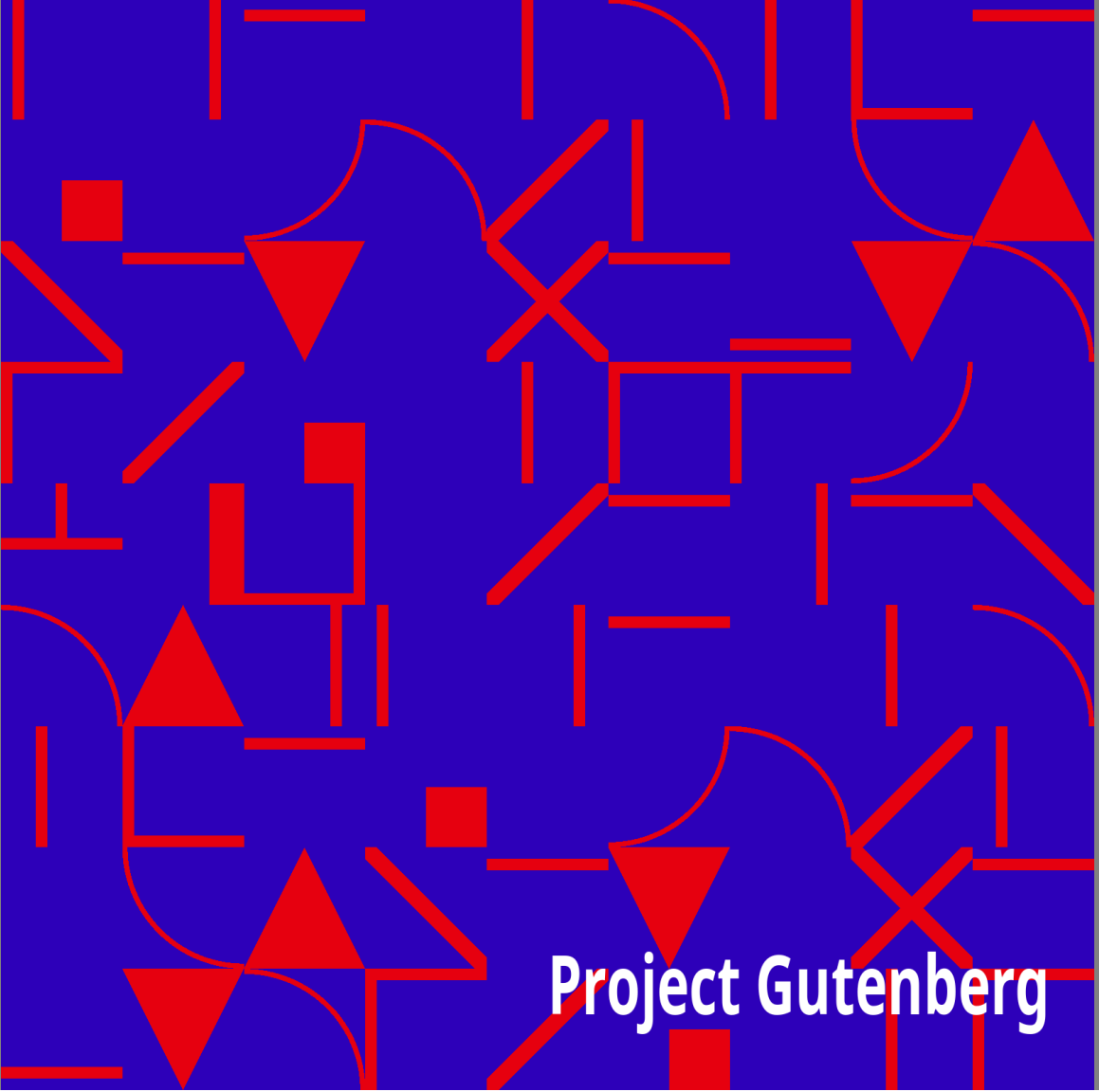
Anonymous

The background of the lower half of the image is a solid blue field. Overlaid on this field is a complex, repeating pattern of red geometric shapes and lines. These include straight lines of various lengths and orientations, right-angled corners, squares, triangles (both pointing up and down), and curved lines that form partial circles or arcs. The pattern is dense and non-representational, serving as a decorative backdrop for the text.

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Nehemiah**

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An abstract geometric pattern consisting of various red shapes (lines, squares, triangles, and arcs) scattered across a blue background.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE BIBLE,
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Book 16 Nehemiah

16:001:001 The words of Nehemiah the son of Hachaliah. And it came to pass in the month Chisleu, in the twentieth year, as I was in Shushan the palace,

16:001:002 That Hanani, one of my brethren, came, he and certain men of Judah; and I asked them concerning the Jews that had escaped, which were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem.

16:001:003 And they said unto me, The remnant that are left of the captivity there in the province are in great affliction and reproach: the wall of Jerusalem also is broken down, and the gates thereof are burned with fire.

16:001:004 And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven,

16:001:005 And said, I beseech thee, O LORD God of heaven, the great and

terrible God, that keepeth covenant and mercy for them that love him and observe his commandments:

16:001:006 Let thine ear now be attentive, and thine eyes open, that thou mayest hear the prayer of thy servant, which I pray before thee now, day and night, for the children of Israel thy servants, and confess the sins of the children of Israel, which we have sinned against thee: both I and my father's house have sinned.

16:001:007 We have dealt very corruptly against thee, and have not kept the commandments, nor the statutes, nor the judgments, which thou commandedst thy servant Moses.

16:001:008 Remember, I beseech thee, the word that thou commandedst thy servant Moses, saying, If ye transgress, I will scatter you abroad among the nations:

16:001:009 But if ye turn unto me, and keep my commandments, and do them; though there were of you cast out unto the uttermost part of the heaven, yet will I gather them from thence, and will bring them unto the place that I have chosen to set my name there.

16:001:010 Now these are thy servants and thy people, whom thou hast redeemed by thy great power, and by thy strong hand.

16:001:011 O LORD, I beseech thee, let now thine ear be attentive to the prayer of thy servant, and to the prayer of thy servants, who desire to fear thy name: and prosper, I pray thee, thy servant this day, and grant him mercy in the sight of this man. For I was the king's cupbearer.

16:002:001 And it came to pass in the month Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king, that wine was before him: and I took up the wine, and gave it unto the king. Now I had not been beforetime sad in his presence.

16:002:002 Wherefore the king said unto me, Why is thy countenance sad, seeing thou art not sick? this is nothing else but sorrow of heart. Then I was very sore afraid,

16:002:003 And said unto the king, Let the king live for ever: why should not my countenance be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers' sepulchres, lieth waste, and the gates thereof are consumed with fire?

16:002:004 Then the king said unto me, For what dost thou make request? So I prayed to the God of heaven.

16:002:005 And I said unto the king, If it please the king, and if thy servant have found favour in thy sight, that thou wouldest send me unto Judah, unto the city of my fathers' sepulchres, that I may build it.

16:002:006 And the king said unto me, (the queen also sitting by him,) For how long shall thy journey be? and when wilt thou return?
So it pleased the king to send me; and I set him a time.

16:002:007 Moreover I said unto the king, If it please the king, let letters be given me to the governors beyond the river, that they may convey me over till I come into Judah;

16:002:008 And a letter unto Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to make beams for the gates of the palace which appertained to the house, and for the wall of the city, and for the house that

I shall enter into. And the king granted me, according to the good hand of my God upon me.

16:002:009 Then I came to the governors beyond the river, and gave them

the king's letters. Now the king had sent captains of the army and horsemen with me.

16:002:010 When Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, heard of it, it grieved them exceedingly that there was come a man to seek the welfare of the children of Israel.

16:002:011 So I came to Jerusalem, and was there three days.

16:002:012 And I arose in the night, I and some few men with me; neither

told I any man what my God had put in my heart to do at Jerusalem: neither was there any beast with me, save the beast that I rode upon.

16:002:013 And I went out by night by the gate of the valley, even before the dragon well, and to the dung port, and viewed the walls of Jerusalem, which were broken down, and the gates thereof were consumed with fire.

16:002:014 Then I went on to the gate of the fountain, and to the king's pool: but there was no place for the beast that was under me to pass.

16:002:015 Then went I up in the night by the brook, and viewed the wall,

and turned back, and entered by the gate of the valley, and so returned.

16:002:016 And the rulers knew not whither I went, or what I did; neither had I as yet told it to the Jews, nor to the priests, nor to the nobles, nor to the rulers, nor to the rest that did the work.

16:002:017 Then said I unto them, Ye see the distress that we are in, how Jerusalem lieth waste, and the gates thereof are burned with fire: come, and let us build up the wall of Jerusalem, that we be no more a reproach.

16:002:018 Then I told them of the hand of my God which was good upon me;

as also the king's words that he had spoken unto me. And they said, Let us rise up and build. So they strengthened their hands for this good work.

16:002:019 But when Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, and Geshem the Arabian, heard it, they laughed us to scorn, and despised us, and said, What is this thing that ye do? will ye rebel against the king?

16:002:020 Then answered I them, and said unto them, The God of heaven,

he will prosper us; therefore we his servants will arise and build: but ye have no portion, nor right, nor memorial, in Jerusalem.

16:003:001 Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his brethren the priests, and they builded the sheep gate; they sanctified it,

and set up the doors of it; even unto the tower of Meah they sanctified it, unto the tower of Hananeel.

16:003:002 And next unto him builded the men of Jericho. And next to them builded Zaccur the son of Imri.

16:003:003 But the fish gate did the sons of Hassenaah build, who also laid the beams thereof, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.

16:003:004 And next unto them repaired Meremoth the son of Urijah, the son of Koz. And next unto them repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah, the son of Meshezabeel. And next unto them repaired Zadok the son of Baana.

16:003:005 And next unto them the Tekoites repaired; but their nobles put not their necks to the work of their LORD.

16:003:006 Moreover the old gate repaired Jehoiada the son of Paseah, and Meshullam the son of Besodeiah; they laid the beams thereof, and set up the doors thereof, and the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.

16:003:007 And next unto them repaired Melatiah the Gibeonite, and Jadon the Meronothite, the men of Gibeon, and of Mizpah, unto the throne of the governor on this side the river.

16:003:008 Next unto him repaired Uzziel the son of Harhaiah, of the goldsmiths. Next unto him also repaired Hananiah the son of one of the apothecaries, and they fortified Jerusalem unto the broad wall.

16:003:009 And next unto them repaired Rephaiah the son of Hur, the ruler of the half part of Jerusalem.

16:003:010 And next unto them repaired Jedaiah the son of Harumaph, even over against his house. And next unto him repaired Hattush the son of Hashabniah.

16:003:011 Malchijah the son of Harim, and Hashub the son of Pahathmoab,
repaired the other piece, and the tower of the furnaces.

16:003:012 And next unto him repaired Shallum the son of Haloresh, the ruler of the half part of Jerusalem, he and his daughters.

16:003:013 The valley gate repaired Hanun, and the inhabitants of Zanoah; they built it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof, and a thousand cubits on the wall unto the dung gate.

16:003:014 But the dung gate repaired Malchiah the son of Rechab, the ruler of part of Bethhaccerem; he built it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof.

16:003:015 But the gate of the fountain repaired Shallun the son of Colhozeh, the ruler of part of Mizpah; he built it, and covered it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof, and the wall of the pool of Siloah by the king's garden, and unto the stairs that go down from the city of David.

16:003:016 After him repaired Nehemiah the son of Azbuk, the ruler of the half part of Bethzur, unto the place over against the sepulchres of David, and to the pool that was made, and unto the house of the mighty.

16:003:017 After him repaired the Levites, Rehum the son of Bani. Next unto him repaired Hashabiah, the ruler of the half part of Keilah, in his part.

16:003:018 After him repaired their brethren, Bavai the son of Henadad, the ruler of the half part of Keilah.

16:003:019 And next to him repaired Ezer the son of Jeshua, the ruler of Mizpah, another piece over against the going up to the armoury at the turning of the wall.

16:003:020 After him Baruch the son of Zabbai earnestly repaired the other piece, from the turning of the wall unto the door of the house of Eliashib the high priest.

16:003:021 After him repaired Meremoth the son of Urijah the son of Koz another piece, from the door of the house of Eliashib even to the end of the house of Eliashib.

16:003:022 And after him repaired the priests, the men of the plain.

16:003:023 After him repaired Benjamin and Hashub over against their house. After him repaired Azariah the son of Maaseiah the son of Ananiah by his house.

16:003:024 After him repaired Binnui the son of Henadad another piece, from the house of Azariah unto the turning of the wall, even unto the corner.

16:003:025 Palal the son of Uzai, over against the turning of the wall, and the tower which lieth out from the king's high house, that was by the court of the prison. After him Pedaiah the son of Parosh.

16:003:026 Moreover the Nethinims dwelt in Ophel, unto the place over against the water gate toward the east, and the tower that lieth out.

16:003:027 After them the Tekoites repaired another piece, over against the great tower that lieth out, even unto the wall of Ophel.

16:003:028 From above the horse gate repaired the priests, every one over against his house.

16:003:029 After them repaired Zadok the son of Immer over against his house. After him repaired also Shemaiah the son of Shechaniah, the keeper of the east gate.

16:003:030 After him repaired Hananiah the son of Shelemiah, and Hanun the sixth son of Zalaph, another piece. After him repaired Meshullam the son of Berechiah over against his chamber.

16:003:031 After him repaired Malchiah the goldsmith's son unto the place of the Nethinims, and of the merchants, over against the gate Miphkad, and to the going up of the corner.

16:003:032 And between the going up of the corner unto the sheep gate repaired the goldsmiths and the merchants.

16:004:001 But it came to pass, that when Sanballat heard that we builded the wall, he was wroth, and took great indignation, and mocked the Jews.

16:004:002 And he spake before his brethren and the army of Samaria, and said, What do these feeble Jews? will they fortify themselves? will they sacrifice? will they make an end in a day? will they revive the stones out of the heaps of the rubbish which are burned?

16:004:003 Now Tobiah the Ammonite was by him, and he said, Even that

which they build, if a fox go up, he shall even break down their stone wall.

16:004:004 Hear, O our God; for we are despised: and turn their reproach upon their own head, and give them for a prey in the land of captivity:

16:004:005 And cover not their iniquity, and let not their sin be blotted out from before thee: for they have provoked thee to anger before the builders.

16:004:006 So built we the wall; and all the wall was joined together unto the half thereof: for the people had a mind to work.

16:004:007 But it came to pass, that when Sanballat, and Tobiah, and the Arabians, and the Ammonites, and the Ashdodites, heard that the walls of Jerusalem were made up, and that the breaches began to be stopped, then they were very wroth,

16:004:008 And conspired all of them together to come and to fight against Jerusalem, and to hinder it.

16:004:009 Nevertheless we made our prayer unto our God, and set a watch against them day and night, because of them.

16:004:010 And Judah said, The strength of the bearers of burdens is decayed, and there is much rubbish; so that we are not able to build the wall.

16:004:011 And our adversaries said, They shall not know, neither see, till we come in the midst among them, and slay them, and cause the work to cease.

16:004:012 And it came to pass, that when the Jews which dwelt by them came, they said unto us ten times, From all places whence ye shall return unto us they will be upon you.

16:004:013 Therefore set I in the lower places behind the wall, and on the higher places, I even set the people after their families with their swords, their spears, and their bows.

16:004:014 And I looked, and rose up, and said unto the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, Be not ye afraid of them: remember the LORD, which is great and terrible, and fight for your brethren, your sons, and your daughters, your wives, and your houses.

16:004:015 And it came to pass, when our enemies heard that it was known unto us, and God had brought their counsel to nought, that we returned all of us to the wall, every one unto his work.

16:004:016 And it came to pass from that time forth, that the half of my servants wrought in the work, and the other half of them held both the spears, the shields, and the bows, and the habergeons; and the rulers were behind all the house of Judah.

16:004:017 They which builded on the wall, and they that bare burdens, with those that laded, every one with one of his hands wrought in the work, and with the other hand held a weapon.

16:004:018 For the builders, every one had his sword girded by his side, and so builded. And he that sounded the trumpet was by me.

16:004:019 And I said unto the nobles, and to the rulers, and to the rest of the people, The work is great and large, and we are separated upon the wall, one far from another.

16:004:020 In what place therefore ye hear the sound of the trumpet, resort ye thither unto us: our God shall fight for us.

16:004:021 So we laboured in the work: and half of them held the spears from the rising of the morning till the stars appeared.

16:004:022 Likewise at the same time said I unto the people, Let every one with his servant lodge within Jerusalem, that in the night they may be a guard to us, and labour on the day.

16:004:023 So neither I, nor my brethren, nor my servants, nor the men of
the guard which followed me, none of us put off our clothes, saving that every one put them off for washing.

16:005:001 And there was a great cry of the people and of their wives against their brethren the Jews.

16:005:002 For there were that said, We, our sons, and our daughters, are many: therefore we take up corn for them, that we may eat, and live.

16:005:003 Some also there were that said, We have mortgaged our lands,
vineyards, and houses, that we might buy corn, because of the dearth.

16:005:004 There were also that said, We have borrowed money for the king's tribute, and that upon our lands and vineyards.

16:005:005 Yet now our flesh is as the flesh of our brethren, our children as their children: and, lo, we bring into bondage our sons and our daughters to be servants, and some of our daughters are brought unto bondage already: neither is it in our power to redeem them; for other men have our lands and vineyards.

16:005:006 And I was very angry when I heard their cry and these words.

16:005:007 Then I consulted with myself, and I rebuked the nobles, and the rulers, and said unto them, Ye exact usury, every one of his brother. And I set a great assembly against them.

16:005:008 And I said unto them, We after our ability have redeemed our brethren the Jews, which were sold unto the heathen; and will ye even sell your brethren? or shall they be sold unto us? Then held they their peace, and found nothing to answer.

16:005:009 Also I said, It is not good that ye do: ought ye not to walk in the fear of our God because of the reproach of the heathen our enemies?

16:005:010 I likewise, and my brethren, and my servants, might exact of them money and corn: I pray you, let us leave off this usury.

16:005:011 Restore, I pray you, to them, even this day, their lands, their vineyards, their oliveyards, and their houses, also the hundredth part of the money, and of the corn, the wine, and the oil, that ye exact of them.

16:005:012 Then said they, We will restore them, and will require nothing of them; so will we do as thou sayest. Then I called the

priests, and took an oath of them, that they should do according to this promise.

16:005:013 Also I shook my lap, and said, So God shake out every man from

his house, and from his labour, that performeth not this promise, even thus be he shaken out, and emptied. And all the congregation said, Amen, and praised the LORD. And the people did according to this promise.

16:005:014 Moreover from the time that I was appointed to be their governor in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year even unto the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes the king, that is, twelve years, I and my brethren have not eaten the bread of the governor.

16:005:015 But the former governors that had been before me were chargeable unto the people, and had taken of them bread and wine, beside forty shekels of silver; yea, even their servants bare rule over the people: but so did not I, because of the fear of God.

16:005:016 Yea, also I continued in the work of this wall, neither bought we any land: and all my servants were gathered thither unto the work.

16:005:017 Moreover there were at my table an hundred and fifty of the Jews and rulers, beside those that came unto us from among the heathen that are about us.

16:005:018 Now that which was prepared for me daily was one ox and six choice sheep; also fowls were prepared for me, and once in ten days

store of all sorts of wine: yet for all this required not I the bread of the governor, because the bondage was heavy upon this people.

16:005:019 Think upon me, my God, for good, according to all that I have done for this people.

16:006:001 Now it came to pass when Sanballat, and Tobiah, and Geshem the Arabian, and the rest of our enemies, heard that I had builded the wall, and that there was no breach left therein; (though at that time I had not set up the doors upon the gates;)

16:006:002 That Sanballat and Geshem sent unto me, saying, Come, let us

meet together in some one of the villages in the plain of Ono.

But they thought to do me mischief.

16:006:003 And I sent messengers unto them, saying, I am doing a great work, so that I cannot come down: why should the work cease, whilst I leave it, and come down to you?

16:006:004 Yet they sent unto me four times after this sort; and I answered them after the same manner.

16:006:005 Then sent Sanballat his servant unto me in like manner the fifth time with an open letter in his hand;

16:006:006 Wherein was written, It is reported among the heathen, and Gashmu saith it, that thou and the Jews think to rebel: for which cause thou buildest the wall, that thou mayest be their king, according to these words.

16:006:007 And thou hast also appointed prophets to preach of thee at Jerusalem, saying, There is a king in Judah: and now shall it

be reported to the king according to these words. Come now therefore, and let us take counsel together.

16:006:008 Then I sent unto him, saying, There are no such things done as thou sayest, but thou feignest them out of thine own heart.

16:006:009 For they all made us afraid, saying, Their hands shall be weakened from the work, that it be not done. Now therefore, O God, strengthen my hands.

16:006:010 Afterward I came unto the house of Shemaiah the son of Delaiah the son of Mehetabeel, who was shut up; and he said, Let us meet together in the house of God, within the temple, and let us shut the doors of the temple: for they will come to slay thee; yea, in the night will they come to slay thee.

16:006:011 And I said, Should such a man as I flee? and who is there, that, being as I am, would go into the temple to save his life? I will not go in.

16:006:012 And, lo, I perceived that God had not sent him; but that he pronounced this prophecy against me: for Tobiah and Sanballat had hired him.

16:006:013 Therefore was he hired, that I should be afraid, and do so, and sin, and that they might have matter for an evil report, that they might reproach me.

16:006:014 My God, think thou upon Tobiah and Sanballat according to these their works, and on the prophetess Noadiah, and the rest of the prophets, that would have put me in fear.

16:006:015 So the wall was finished in the twenty and fifth day of the month Elul, in fifty and two days.

16:006:016 And it came to pass, that when all our enemies heard thereof, and all the heathen that were about us saw these things, they were much cast down in their own eyes: for they perceived that this work was wrought of our God.

16:006:017 Moreover in those days the nobles of Judah sent many letters unto Tobiah, and the letters of Tobiah came unto them.

16:006:018 For there were many in Judah sworn unto him, because he was the son in law of Shechaniah the son of Arah; and his son Johanan had taken the daughter of Meshullam the son of Berechiah.

16:006:019 Also they reported his good deeds before me, and uttered my words to him. And Tobiah sent letters to put me in fear.

16:007:001 Now it came to pass, when the wall was built, and I had set up

the doors, and the porters and the singers and the Levites were appointed,

16:007:002 That I gave my brother Hanani, and Hananiah the ruler of the palace, charge over Jerusalem: for he was a faithful man, and feared God above many.

16:007:003 And I said unto them, Let not the gates of Jerusalem be opened until the sun be hot; and while they stand by, let them shut the doors, and bar them: and appoint watches of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, every one in his watch, and every one to be over against his house.

16:007:004 Now the city was large and great: but the people were few therein, and the houses were not builded.

16:007:005 And my God put into mine heart to gather together the nobles,

and the rulers, and the people, that they might be reckoned by genealogy. And I found a register of the genealogy of them which came up at the first, and found written therein,

16:007:006 These are the children of the province, that went up out of the captivity, of those that had been carried away, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away, and came again to Jerusalem and to Judah, every one unto his city;

16:007:007 Who came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah,

Nahamani, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum, Baanah. The number, I say, of the men of the people of Israel was this;

16:007:008 The children of Parosh, two thousand an hundred seventy and two.

16:007:009 The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy and two.

16:007:010 The children of Arah, six hundred fifty and two.

16:007:011 The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand and eight hundred and eighteen.

16:007:012 The children of Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.

16:007:013 The children of Zattu, eight hundred forty and five.

16:007:014 The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and threescore.

16:007:015 The children of Binnui, six hundred forty and eight.

16:007:016 The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and eight.

16:007:017 The children of Azgad, two thousand three hundred twenty and two.

16:007:018 The children of Adonikam, six hundred threescore and seven.

16:007:019 The children of Bigvai, two thousand threescore and seven.

16:007:020 The children of Adin, six hundred fifty and five.

16:007:021 The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninety and eight.

16:007:022 The children of Hashum, three hundred twenty and eight.

16:007:023 The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and four.

16:007:024 The children of Hariph, an hundred and twelve.

16:007:025 The children of Gibeon, ninety and five.

16:007:026 The men of Bethlehem and Netophah, an hundred fourscore and eight.

16:007:027 The men of Anathoth, an hundred twenty and eight.

16:007:028 The men of Bethazmaveth, forty and two.

16:007:029 The men of Kirjathjearim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred forty and three.

16:007:030 The men of Ramah and Gaba, six hundred twenty and one.

16:007:031 The men of Michmas, an hundred and twenty and two.

16:007:032 The men of Bethel and Ai, an hundred twenty and three.

16:007:033 The men of the other Nebo, fifty and two.

16:007:034 The children of the other Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.

16:007:035 The children of Harim, three hundred and twenty.

16:007:036 The children of Jericho, three hundred forty and five.

16:007:037 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and one.

16:007:038 The children of Senaah, three thousand nine hundred and thirty.

16:007:039 The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy and three.

16:007:040 The children of Immer, a thousand fifty and two.

16:007:041 The children of Pashur, a thousand two hundred forty and seven.

16:007:042 The children of Harim, a thousand and seventeen.

16:007:043 The Levites: the children of Jeshua, of Kadmiel, and of the children of Hodevah, seventy and four.

16:007:044 The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred forty and eight.

16:007:045 The porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, an hundred thirty and eight.

16:007:046 The Nethinims: the children of Ziha, the children of Hashupha,
the children of Tabbaoth,

16:007:047 The children of Keros, the children of Sia, the children of Padon,

16:007:048 The children of Lebana, the children of Hagaba, the children of Shalmai,

16:007:049 The children of Hanan, the children of Giddel, the children of Gahar,

16:007:050 The children of Reaiah, the children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda,

16:007:051 The children of Gazzam, the children of Uzza, the children of Phaseah,

16:007:052 The children of Besai, the children of Meunim, the children of
Nephishesim,

16:007:053 The children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children
of Harhur,

16:007:054 The children of Bazlith, the children of Mehida, the children of Harsha,

16:007:055 The children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Tamah,

16:007:056 The children of Neziah, the children of Hatipha.

16:007:057 The children of Solomon's servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Perida,

16:007:058 The children of Jaala, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,

16:007:059 The children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth of Zebaim, the children of Amon.

16:007:060 All the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety and two.

16:007:061 And these were they which went up also from Telmelah, Telharesha, Cherub, Addon, and Immer: but they could not shew their father's house, nor their seed, whether they were of Israel.

16:007:062 The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred forty and two.

16:007:063 And of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Koz, the children of Barzillai, which took one of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite to wife, and was called after their name.

16:007:064 These sought their register among those that were reckoned by

genealogy, but it was not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.

16:007:065 And the Tirshatha said unto them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, till there stood up a priest with Urim and Thummim.

16:007:066 The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and threescore,

16:007:067 Beside their manservants and their maidservants, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven: and they had two hundred forty and five singing men and singing women.

16:007:068 Their horses, seven hundred thirty and six: their mules, two hundred forty and five:

16:007:069 Their camels, four hundred thirty and five: six thousand seven hundred and twenty asses.

16:007:070 And some of the chief of the fathers gave unto the work. The Tirshatha gave to the treasure a thousand drams of gold, fifty basons, five hundred and thirty priests' garments.

16:007:071 And some of the chief of the fathers gave to the treasure of the work twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand and two hundred pound of silver.

16:007:072 And that which the rest of the people gave was twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand pound of silver, and threescore and seven priests' garments.

16:007:073 So the priests, and the Levites, and the porters, and the singers, and some of the people, and the Nethinims, and all Israel, dwelt in their cities; and when the seventh month came, the children of Israel were in their cities.

16:008:001 And all the people gathered themselves together as one man into the street that was before the water gate; and they spake unto Ezra the scribe to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded to Israel.

16:008:002 And Ezra the priest brought the law before the congregation both of men and women, and all that could hear with understanding, upon the first day of the seventh month.

16:008:003 And he read therein before the street that was before the water gate from the morning until midday, before the men and the women, and those that could understand; and the ears of all the people were attentive unto the book of the law.

16:008:004 And Ezra the scribe stood upon a pulpit of wood, which they had made for the purpose; and beside him stood Mattithiah, and Shema, and Anaiah, and Urijah, and Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, on his right hand; and on his left hand, Pedaiah, and Mishael, and Malchiah, and Hashum, and Hashbadana, Zechariah, and Meshullam.

16:008:005 And Ezra opened the book in the sight of all the people; (for he was above all the people;) and when he opened it, all the people stood up:

16:008:006 And Ezra blessed the LORD, the great God. And all the people answered, Amen, Amen, with lifting up their hands: and they

bowed their heads, and worshipped the LORD with their faces to the ground.

16:008:007 Also Jeshua, and Bani, and Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodijah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Pelaiah, and the Levites, caused the people to understand the law: and the people stood in their place.

16:008:008 So they read in the book in the law of God distinctly, and gave the sense, and caused them to understand the reading.

16:008:009 And Nehemiah, which is the Tirshatha, and Ezra the priest the scribe, and the Levites that taught the people, said unto all the people, This day is holy unto the LORD your God; mourn not, nor weep. For all the people wept, when they heard the words of the law.

16:008:010 Then he said unto them, Go your way, eat the fat, and drink the sweet, and send portions unto them for whom nothing is prepared: for this day is holy unto our LORD: neither be ye sorry; for the joy of the LORD is your strength.

16:008:011 So the Levites stilled all the people, saying, Hold your peace, for the day is holy; neither be ye grieved.

16:008:012 And all the people went their way to eat, and to drink, and to send portions, and to make great mirth, because they had understood the words that were declared unto them.

16:008:013 And on the second day were gathered together the chief of the fathers of all the people, the priests, and the Levites, unto Ezra the scribe, even to understand the words of the law.

16:008:014 And they found written in the law which the LORD had commanded

by Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in booths in the feast of the seventh month:

16:008:015 And that they should publish and proclaim in all their cities, and in Jerusalem, saying, Go forth unto the mount, and fetch olive branches, and pine branches, and myrtle branches, and palm branches, and branches of thick trees, to make booths, as it is written.

16:008:016 So the people went forth, and brought them, and made themselves booths, every one upon the roof of his house, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the street of the water gate, and in the street of the gate of Ephraim.

16:008:017 And all the congregation of them that were come again out of the captivity made booths, and sat under the booths: for since the days of Jeshua the son of Nun unto that day had not the children of Israel done so. And there was very great gladness.

16:008:018 Also day by day, from the first day unto the last day, he read in the book of the law of God. And they kept the feast seven days; and on the eighth day was a solemn assembly, according unto the manner.

16:009:001 Now in the twenty and fourth day of this month the children of

Israel were assembled with fasting, and with sackclothes, and earth upon them.

16:009:002 And the seed of Israel separated themselves from all strangers, and stood and confessed their sins, and the iniquities of their fathers.

16:009:003 And they stood up in their place, and read in the book of the law of the LORD their God one fourth part of the day; and another fourth part they confessed, and worshipped the LORD their God.

16:009:004 Then stood up upon the stairs, of the Levites, Jeshua, and Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani, and cried with a loud voice unto the LORD their God.

16:009:005 Then the Levites, Jeshua, and Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabniah, Sherebiah, Hodijah, Shebaniah, and Pethahiah, said, Stand up and bless the LORD your God for ever and ever: and blessed be thy glorious name, which is exalted above all blessing and praise.

16:009:006 Thou, even thou, art LORD alone; thou hast made heaven, the
heaven of heavens, with all their host, the earth, and all things that are therein, the seas, and all that is therein, and thou preservest them all; and the host of heaven worshippeth thee.

16:009:007 Thou art the LORD the God, who didst choose Abram, and broughtest him forth out of Ur of the Chaldees, and gavest him the name of Abraham;

16:009:008 And foundest his heart faithful before thee, and madest a covenant with him to give the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the

Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Jebusites, and the Gergashites, to give it, I say, to his seed, and hast performed thy words; for thou art righteous:

16:009:009 And didst see the affliction of our fathers in Egypt, and heardest their cry by the Red sea;

16:009:010 And shewedst signs and wonders upon Pharaoh, and on all his

servants, and on all the people of his land: for thou knewest that they dealt proudly against them. So didst thou get thee a name, as it is this day.

16:009:011 And thou didst divide the sea before them, so that they went through the midst of the sea on the dry land; and their persecutors thou threwest into the deeps, as a stone into the mighty waters.

16:009:012 Moreover thou leddest them in the day by a cloudy pillar; and

in the night by a pillar of fire, to give them light in the way wherein they should go.

16:009:013 Thou camest down also upon mount Sinai, and spakest with them

from heaven, and gavest them right judgments, and true laws, good statutes and commandments:

16:009:014 And madest known unto them thy holy sabbath, and commandedst

them precepts, statutes, and laws, by the hand of Moses thy servant:

16:009:015 And gavest them bread from heaven for their hunger, and broughtest forth water for them out of the rock for their thirst, and promisedst them that they should go in to possess the land which thou hadst sworn to give them.

16:009:016 But they and our fathers dealt proudly, and hardened their necks, and hearkened not to thy commandments,

16:009:017 And refused to obey, neither were mindful of thy wonders that thou didst among them; but hardened their necks, and in their rebellion appointed a captain to return to their bondage: but thou art a God ready to pardon, gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness, and forsookest them not.

16:009:018 Yea, when they had made them a molten calf, and said, This is thy God that brought thee up out of Egypt, and had wrought great provocations;

16:009:019 Yet thou in thy manifold mercies forsookest them not in the wilderness: the pillar of the cloud departed not from them by day, to lead them in the way; neither the pillar of fire by night, to shew them light, and the way wherein they should go.

16:009:020 Thou gavest also thy good spirit to instruct them, and withheldest not thy manna from their mouth, and gavest them water for their thirst.

16:009:021 Yea, forty years didst thou sustain them in the wilderness, so that they lacked nothing; their clothes waxed not old, and their feet swelled not.

16:009:022 Moreover thou gavest them kingdoms and nations, and didst divide them into corners: so they possessed the land of Sihon, and the land of the king of Heshbon, and the land of Og king of Bashan.

16:009:023 Their children also multipliedst thou as the stars of heaven, and broughtest them into the land, concerning which thou hadst promised to their fathers, that they should go in to possess it.

16:009:024 So the children went in and possessed the land, and thou subduedst before them the inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, and gavest them into their hands, with their kings, and the people of the land, that they might do with them as they would.

16:009:025 And they took strong cities, and a fat land, and possessed houses full of all goods, wells digged, vineyards, and oliveyards, and fruit trees in abundance: so they did eat, and were filled, and became fat, and delighted themselves in thy great goodness.

16:009:026 Nevertheless they were disobedient, and rebelled against thee, and cast thy law behind their backs, and slew thy prophets which testified against them to turn them to thee, and they wrought great provocations.

16:009:027 Therefore thou deliveredst them into the hand of their enemies, who vexed them: and in the time of their trouble, when they cried unto thee, thou heardest them from heaven; and according to thy manifold mercies thou gavest them saviours, who saved them out of the hand of their enemies.

16:009:028 But after they had rest, they did evil again before thee:
therefore leftest thou them in the land of their enemies, so
that they had the dominion over them: yet when they returned,
and cried unto thee, thou heardest them from heaven; and many
times didst thou deliver them according to thy mercies;

16:009:029 And testifiedst against them, that thou mightest bring them
again unto thy law: yet they dealt proudly, and hearkened not
unto thy commandments, but sinned against thy judgments,
(which if a man do, he shall live in them;) and withdrew the
shoulder, and hardened their neck, and would not hear.

16:009:030 Yet many years didst thou forbear them, and testifiedst
against them by thy spirit in thy prophets: yet would they not give ear:
therefore gavest thou them into the hand of the people of the lands.

16:009:031 Nevertheless for thy great mercies' sake thou didst not utterly
consume them, nor forsake them; for thou art a gracious and merciful God.

16:009:032 Now therefore, our God, the great, the mighty, and the
terrible God, who keepest covenant and mercy, let not all the trouble seem
little before thee, that hath come upon us, on our kings, on our princes, and
on our priests, and on our prophets, and on our fathers, and on all thy
people, since the time of the kings of Assyria unto this day.

16:009:033 Howbeit thou art just in all that is brought upon us; for thou
hast done right, but we have done wickedly:

16:009:034 Neither have our kings, our princes, our priests, nor our
fathers, kept thy law, nor hearkened unto thy commandments and thy
testimonies, wherewith thou didst testify against them.

16:009:035 For they have not served thee in their kingdom, and in thy great goodness that thou gavest them, and in the large and fat land which thou gavest before them, neither turned they from their wicked works.

16:009:036 Behold, we are servants this day, and for the land that thou gavest unto our fathers to eat the fruit thereof and the good thereof, behold, we are servants in it:

16:009:037 And it yieldeth much increase unto the kings whom thou hast set over us because of our sins: also they have dominion over our bodies, and over our cattle, at their pleasure, and we are in great distress.

16:009:038 And because of all this we make a sure covenant, and write it;

and our princes, Levites, and priests, seal unto it.

16:010:001 Now those that sealed were, Nehemiah, the Tirshatha, the son of Hachaliah, and Zidkijah,

16:010:002 Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah,

16:010:003 Pashur, Amariah, Malchijah,

16:010:004 Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch,

16:010:005 Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah,

16:010:006 Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,

16:010:007 Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin,

16:010:008 Maaziah, Bilgai, Shemaiah: these were the priests.

16:010:009 And the Levites: both Jeshua the son of Azaniah, Binnui of the

sons of Henadad, Kadmiel;

16:010:010 And their brethren, Shebaniah, Hodijah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan,

16:010:011 Micha, Rehob, Hashabiah,

16:010:012 Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,

16:010:013 Hodijah, Bani, Beninu.

16:010:014 The chief of the people; Parosh, Pahathmoab, Elam, Zatthu, Bani,

16:010:015 Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,

16:010:016 Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,

16:010:017 Ater, Hizkijah, Azzur,

16:010:018 Hodijah, Hashum, Bezai,

16:010:019 Hariph, Anathoth, Nebai,

16:010:020 Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,

16:010:021 Meshezabeel, Zadok, Jaddua,

16:010:022 Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah,

16:010:023 Hoshea, Hananiah, Hashub,

16:010:024 Hallohesh, Pileha, Shobek,

16:010:025 Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,

16:010:026 And Ahijah, Hanan, Anan,

16:010:027 Malluch, Harim, Baanah.

16:010:028 And the rest of the people, the priests, the Levites, the porters, the singers, the Nethinims, and all they that had separated themselves from the people of the lands unto the law of God, their wives, their sons, and their daughters, every one having knowledge, and having understanding;

16:010:029 They clave to their brethren, their nobles, and entered into a curse, and into an oath, to walk in God's law, which was given by Moses the servant of God, and to observe and do all the commandments of the LORD our Lord, and his judgments and his statutes;

16:010:030 And that we would not give our daughters unto the people of the land, not take their daughters for our sons:

16:010:031 And if the people of the land bring ware or any victuals on the sabbath day to sell, that we would not buy it of them on the sabbath, or on the holy day: and that we would leave the seventh year, and the exaction of every debt.

16:010:032 Also we made ordinances for us, to charge ourselves yearly with the third part of a shekel for the service of the house of our God;

16:010:033 For the shewbread, and for the continual meat offering, and for the continual burnt offering, of the sabbaths, of the new moons, for the set feasts, and for the holy things, and for

the sin offerings to make an atonement for Israel, and for all the work of the house of our God.

16:010:034 And we cast the lots among the priests, the Levites, and the people, for the wood offering, to bring it into the house of our God, after the houses of our fathers, at times appointed year by year, to burn upon the altar of the LORD our God, as it is written in the law:

16:010:035 And to bring the firstfruits of our ground, and the firstfruits of all fruit of all trees, year by year, unto the house of the LORD:

16:010:036 Also the firstborn of our sons, and of our cattle, as it is written in the law, and the firstlings of our herds and of our flocks, to bring to the house of our God, unto the priests that minister in the house of our God:

16:010:037 And that we should bring the firstfruits of our dough, and our offerings, and the fruit of all manner of trees, of wine and of oil, unto the priests, to the chambers of the house of our God; and the tithes of our ground unto the Levites, that the same Levites might have the tithes in all the cities of our tillage.

16:010:038 And the priest the son of Aaron shall be with the Levites, when the Levites take tithes: and the Levites shall bring up the tithe of the tithes unto the house of our God, to the chambers, into the treasure house.

16:010:039 For the children of Israel and the children of Levi shall bring the offering of the corn, of the new wine, and the oil, unto the chambers, where are the vessels of the sanctuary, and the priests that minister, and the porters, and the singers: and we will not forsake the house of our God.

16:011:001 And the rulers of the people dwelt at Jerusalem: the rest of the people also cast lots, to bring one of ten to dwell in Jerusalem the holy city, and nine parts to dwell in other cities.

16:011:002 And the people blessed all the men, that willingly offered themselves to dwell at Jerusalem.

16:011:003 Now these are the chief of the province that dwelt in Jerusalem: but in the cities of Judah dwelt every one in his possession in their cities, to wit, Israel, the priests, and the Levites, and the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants.

16:011:004 And at Jerusalem dwelt certain of the children of Judah, and of the children of Benjamin. Of the children of Judah; Athaiah the son of Uzziah, the son of Zechariah, the son of Amariah, the son of Shephatiah, the son of Mahalaleel, of the children of Perez;

16:011:005 And Maaseiah the son of Baruch, the son of Colhozeh, the son of Hazaiah, the son of Adaiah, the son of Joiarib, the son of Zechariah, the son of Shiloni.

16:011:006 All the sons of Perez that dwelt at Jerusalem were four hundred threescore and eight valiant men.

16:011:007 And these are the sons of Benjamin; Sallu the son of Meshullam, the son of Joed, the son of Pedaiah, the son of Kolaiah, the son of Maaseiah, the son of Ithiel, the son of Jesaiah.

16:011:008 And after him Gabbai, Sallai, nine hundred twenty and eight.

16:011:009 And Joel the son of Zichri was their overseer: and Judah the son of Senuah was second over the city.

16:011:010 Of the priests: Jedaiah the son of Joiarib, Jachin.

16:011:011 Seraiah the son of Hilkihah, the son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, was the ruler of the house of God.

16:011:012 And their brethren that did the work of the house were eight hundred twenty and two: and Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son of Zechariah, the son of Pashur, the son of Malchiah.

16:011:013 And his brethren, chief of the fathers, two hundred forty and two: and Amashai the son of Azareel, the son of Ahasai, the son of Meshillemoth, the son of Immer,

16:011:014 And their brethren, mighty men of valour, an hundred twenty and eight: and their overseer was Zabdiel, the son of one of the great men.

16:011:015 Also of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hashub, the son of Azrikam, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Bunni;

16:011:016 And Shabbethai and Jozabad, of the chief of the Levites, had the oversight of the outward business of the house of God.

16:011:017 And Mattaniah the son of Micha, the son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, was the principal to begin the thanksgiving in prayer: and Bakbukiah the second among his brethren, and Abda the son of Shammua, the son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun.

16:011:018 All the Levites in the holy city were two hundred fourscore and four.

16:011:019 Moreover the porters, Akkub, Talmon, and their brethren that kept the gates, were an hundred seventy and two.

16:011:020 And the residue of Israel, of the priests, and the Levites, were in all the cities of Judah, every one in his inheritance.

16:011:021 But the Nethinims dwelt in Ophel: and Ziha and Gispa were over the Nethinims.

16:011:022 The overseer also of the Levites at Jerusalem was Uzzi the son of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Micha. Of the sons of Asaph, the singers were over the business of the house of God.

16:011:023 For it was the king's commandment concerning them, that a certain portion should be for the singers, due for every day.

16:011:024 And Pethahiah the son of Meshezabeel, of the children of Zerah the son of Judah, was at the king's hand in all matters concerning the people.

16:011:025 And for the villages, with their fields, some of the children of Judah dwelt at Kirjatharba, and in the villages thereof, and at Dibon, and in the villages thereof, and at Jekabzeel, and in the villages thereof,

16:011:026 And at Jeshua, and at Moladah, and at Bethphelet,

16:011:027 And at Hazarshual, and at Beersheba, and in the villages thereof,

16:011:028 And at Ziklag, and at Mekonah, and in the villages thereof,

16:011:029 And at Enrimmon, and at Zareah, and at Jarmuth,

16:011:030 Zanoah, Adullam, and in their villages, at Lachish, and the fields thereof, at Azekah, and in the villages thereof. And they dwelt from Beersheba unto the valley of Hinnom.

16:011:031 The children also of Benjamin from Geba dwelt at Michmash, and Aiya, and Bethel, and in their villages.

16:011:032 And at Anathoth, Nob, Ananiah,

16:011:033 Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim,

16:011:034 Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat,

16:011:035 Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftsmen.

16:011:036 And of the Levites were divisions in Judah, and in Benjamin.

16:012:001 Now these are the priests and the Levites that went up with Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra,

16:012:002 Amariah, Malluch, Hattush,

16:012:003 Shechaniah, Rehum, Meremoth,

16:012:004 Iddo, Ginnetho, Abijah,

16:012:005 Miamin, Maadiah, Bilgah,

16:012:006 Shemaiah, and Joiarib, Jedaiah,

16:012:007 Sallu, Amok, Hilkih, Jedaiah. These were the chief of the priests and of their brethren in the days of Jeshua.

16:012:008 Moreover the Levites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah, and Mattaniah, which was over the thanksgiving, he and his brethren.

16:012:009 Also Bakbukiah and Unni, their brethren, were over against them in the watches.

16:012:010 And Jeshua begat Joiakim, Joiakim also begat Eliashib, and Eliashib begat Joiada,

16:012:011 And Joiada begat Jonathan, and Jonathan begat Jaddua.

16:012:012 And in the days of Joiakim were priests, the chief of the fathers: of Seraiah, Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah;

16:012:013 Of Ezra, Meshullam; of Amariah, Jehohanan;

16:012:014 Of Melicu, Jonathan; of Shebaniah, Joseph;

16:012:015 Of Harim, Adna; of Meraioth, Helkai;

16:012:016 Of Iddo, Zechariah; of Ginnethon, Meshullam;

16:012:017 Of Abijah, Zichri; of Miniamin, of Moadiah, Piltai:

16:012:018 Of Bilgah, Shammua; of Shemaiah, Jehonathan;

16:012:019 And of Joiarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah, Uzzi;

16:012:020 Of Sallai, Kallai; of Amok, Eber;

16:012:021 Of Hilkiah, Hashabiah; of Jedaiah, Nethaneel.

16:012:022 The Levites in the days of Eliashib, Joiada, and Johanan, and Jaddua, were recorded chief of the fathers: also the priests, to the reign of Darius the Persian.

16:012:023 The sons of Levi, the chief of the fathers, were written in the book of the chronicles, even until the days of Johanan the son of Eliashib.

16:012:024 And the chief of the Levites: Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Jeshua the son of Kadmiel, with their brethren over against them, to praise and to give thanks, according to the commandment of David the man of God, ward over against ward.

16:012:025 Mattaniah, and Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, Akkub, were porters keeping the ward at the thresholds of the gates.

16:012:026 These were in the days of Joiakim the son of Jeshua, the son of Jozadak, and in the days of Nehemiah the governor, and of Ezra the priest, the scribe.

16:012:027 And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem they sought the Levites out of all their places, to bring them to Jerusalem, to keep the dedication with gladness, both with thanksgivings, and with singing, with cymbals, psalteries, and with harps.

16:012:028 And the sons of the singers gathered themselves together, both
out of the plain country round about Jerusalem, and from the villages of Netophathi;

16:012:029 Also from the house of Gilgal, and out of the fields of Geba and Azmaveth: for the singers had builded them villages round about Jerusalem.

16:012:030 And the priests and the Levites purified themselves, and purified the people, and the gates, and the wall.

16:012:031 Then I brought up the princes of Judah upon the wall, and appointed two great companies of them that gave thanks, whereof one went on the right hand upon the wall toward the dung gate:

16:012:032 And after them went Hoshai, and half of the princes of Judah,

16:012:033 And Azariah, Ezra, and Meshullam,

16:012:034 Judah, and Benjamin, and Shemaiah, and Jeremiah,

16:012:035 And certain of the priests' sons with trumpets; namely, Zechariah the son of Jonathan, the son of Shemaiah, the son of Mattaniah, the son of Michaiah, the son of Zaccur, the son of Asaph:

16:012:036 And his brethren, Shemaiah, and Azarael, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethaneel, and Judah, Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God, and Ezra the scribe before them.

16:012:037 And at the fountain gate, which was over against them, they went up by the stairs of the city of David, at the going up of the wall, above the house of David, even unto the water gate eastward.

16:012:038 And the other company of them that gave thanks went over against them, and I after them, and the half of the people upon the wall, from beyond the tower of the furnaces even unto the broad wall;

16:012:039 And from above the gate of Ephraim, and above the old gate, and above the fish gate, and the tower of Hananeel, and the tower of Meah, even unto the sheep gate: and they stood still in the prison gate.

16:012:040 So stood the two companies of them that gave thanks in the house of God, and I, and the half of the rulers with me:

16:012:041 And the priests; Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Michaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah, with trumpets;

16:012:042 And Maaseiah, and Shemaiah, and Eleazar, and Uzzi, and Jehohanan, and Malchijah, and Elam, and Ezer. And the singers sang loud, with Jezrahiah their overseer.

16:012:043 Also that day they offered great sacrifices, and rejoiced: for God had made them rejoice with great joy: the wives also and the children rejoiced: so that the joy of Jerusalem was heard even afar off.

16:012:044 And at that time were some appointed over the chambers for the treasures, for the offerings, for the firstfruits, and for the tithes, to gather into them out of the fields of the cities the portions of the law for the priests and Levites: for Judah rejoiced for the priests and for the Levites that waited.

16:012:045 And both the singers and the porters kept the ward of their God, and the ward of the purification, according to the commandment of

David, and of Solomon his son.

16:012:046 For in the days of David and Asaph of old there were chief of the singers, and songs of praise and thanksgiving unto God.

16:012:047 And all Israel in the days of Zerubbabel, and in the days of Nehemiah, gave the portions of the singers and the porters, every day his portion: and they sanctified holy things unto the Levites; and the Levites sanctified them unto the children of Aaron.

16:013:001 On that day they read in the book of Moses in the audience of the people; and therein was found written, that the Ammonite and the Moabite should not come into the congregation of God for ever;

16:013:002 Because they met not the children of Israel with bread and with water, but hired Balaam against them, that he should curse them: howbeit our God turned the curse into a blessing.

16:013:003 Now it came to pass, when they had heard the law, that they separated from Israel all the mixed multitude.

16:013:004 And before this, Eliashib the priest, having the oversight of the chamber of the house of our God, was allied unto Tobiah:

16:013:005 And he had prepared for him a great chamber, where aforetime they laid the meat offerings, the frankincense, and the vessels, and the tithes of the corn, the new wine, and the oil, which was commanded to be given to the Levites, and the singers, and the porters; and the offerings of the priests.

16:013:006 But in all this time was not I at Jerusalem: for in the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon came I unto the king, and after certain days obtained I leave of the king:

16:013:007 And I came to Jerusalem, and understood of the evil that Eliashib did for Tobiah, in preparing him a chamber in the courts of the house of God.

16:013:008 And it grieved me sore: therefore I cast forth all the household stuff to Tobiah out of the chamber.

16:013:009 Then I commanded, and they cleansed the chambers: and thither brought I again the vessels of the house of God, with the meat offering and the frankincense.

16:013:010 And I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them: for the Levites and the singers, that did the work, were fled every one to his field.

16:013:011 Then contended I with the rulers, and said, Why is the house of God forsaken? And I gathered them together, and set them in their place.

16:013:012 Then brought all Judah the tithe of the corn and the new wine and the oil unto the treasuries.

16:013:013 And I made treasurers over the treasuries, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Pedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah: for they were counted faithful, and their office was to distribute unto their brethren.

16:013:014 Remember me, O my God, concerning this, and wipe not out my good deeds that I have done for the house of my God, and for the offices thereof.

16:013:015 In those days saw I in Judah some treading wine presses on the sabbath, and bringing in sheaves, and lading asses; as also wine, grapes, and figs, and all manner of burdens, which they brought into Jerusalem on the sabbath day: and I testified against them in the day wherein they sold victuals.

16:013:016 There dwelt men of Tyre also therein, which brought fish, and

all manner of ware, and sold on the sabbath unto the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem.

16:013:017 Then I contended with the nobles of Judah, and said unto them,

What evil thing is this that ye do, and profane the sabbath day?

16:013:018 Did not your fathers thus, and did not our God bring all this evil upon us, and upon this city? yet ye bring more wrath upon Israel by profaning the sabbath.

16:013:019 And it came to pass, that when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the sabbath, I commanded that the gates should be shut, and charged that they should not be opened till after the sabbath: and some of my servants set I at the gates, that there should no burden be brought in on the sabbath day.

16:013:020 So the merchants and sellers of all kind of ware lodged without Jerusalem once or twice.

16:013:021 Then I testified against them, and said unto them, Why lodge ye about the wall? if ye do so again, I will lay hands on you. From that time forth came they no more on the sabbath.

16:013:022 And I commanded the Levites that they should cleanse themselves, and that they should come and keep the gates, to sanctify the sabbath day. Remember me, O my God, concerning this also, and spare me according to the greatness of thy mercy.

16:013:023 In those days also saw I Jews that had married wives of Ashdod, of Ammon, and of Moab:

16:013:024 And their children spake half in the speech of Ashdod, and could not speak in the Jews' language, but according to the language of each people.

16:013:025 And I contended with them, and cursed them, and smote certain

of them, and plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, saying, Ye shall not give your daughters unto their sons, nor take their daughters unto your sons, or for yourselves.

16:013:026 Did not Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? yet among

many nations was there no king like him, who was beloved of his God, and God made him king over all Israel: nevertheless even him did outlandish women cause to sin.

16:013:027 Shall we then hearken unto you to do all this great evil, to transgress against our God in marrying strange wives?

16:013:028 And one of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was son in law to Sanballat the Horonite: therefore I chased him from me.

16:013:029 Remember them, O my God, because they have defiled the priesthood, and the covenant of the priesthood, and of the Levites.

16:013:030 Thus cleansed I them from all strangers, and appointed the wards of the priests and the Levites, every one in his business;

16:013:031 And for the wood offering, at times appointed, and for the firstfruits. Remember me, O my God, for good.

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